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Against Trump-boosted odds, some women’s colleges thrive

By Brooke Hauser
GLOBE STAFF
SOUTH HADLEY — Growing up in Nigeria, Nathania Amadi dreamed of going to Howard University in Washington. She’d never heard of Mount Holyoke until a college consultant told her about it.

“I was a little terrified of PWIs,” she said, shorthand for “predominantly white institutions.” She wasn’t particularly drawn to the idea of a women’s college, either, but then she saw the financial aid package, “and I was like, ‘whoa.’” Amadi is now a senior at

Mount Holyoke, where nearly a quarter of the student body is international. She’s studying neuroscience when she isn’t campaigning for more bus routes as president of the Student Government Association or volunteering with the campus chapter of **WOMEN’S COLLEGES, Page A7**



Nathania Amadi (left), a student from Nigeria, chatted with Tiffany Sanchez at Mount Holyoke College in South Hadley.

Peace pact in Ukraine elusive as talks end

Rubio cites progress, calls for deal to help Kyiv prosper

By Josh Boak and Aamer Madhani
ASSOCIATED PRESS
HALLANDALE BEACH, Fla. — US and Ukrainian officials completed roughly four hours of talks Sunday aimed at finding an endgame to the war between Russia and Ukraine, just days before a US envoy is due in Moscow for talks with Russian President Vladimir Putin.
Secretary of State Marco Rubio told reporters afterward that the session with the Ukrainian team in Florida was productive but work remains in the search for a peace deal.
“It’s not just about the terms that ends fighting,” Rubio said. “It’s about also the terms that set up Ukraine for long-term prosperity. . . . I think we built on that today, but there’s more work to be done.”
President Trump’s special envoy, Steve Witkoff, is scheduled to meet with Putin in Moscow in the next few days.
Rubio, Witkoff, and Jared Kushner, Trump’s son-in-law, represented the American side in the high-level talks, held at a sensitive time as Ukraine continues to push back against Russian forces that invaded in 2022 while dealing with a corruption scandal.
Trump told reporters aboard Air Force One that he was briefed by them and that “Ukraine’s got some difficult little problems,” referring to the corruption scandal, which he said was “not helpful.” The president added that “there’s a good chance we can make a deal.”
Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky’s government has been roiled by fallout from a scandal over \$100 million embezzled from the energy sector through kickbacks paid by contractors, causing new domestic pressures for Zelensky.
Diplomats have focused on revisions to a proposed US-authored plan that was developed in ne- **UKRAINE, Page A5**



Doug Hano has struggled to find adequate home care for his wife, Kirsten, 58, who is diagnosed with early onset Alzheimer’s. He is advocating for a bill that would create standards for private home care companies in Massachusetts.

Agencies that serve vulnerable may finally receive oversight

Bill advances in Mass. to license, set standards for private home care firms

By Jason Laughlin
GLOBE STAFF
Doug Hano has struggled for years to find reliable care for his wife, Kirsten, who has early-onset Alzheimer’s disease.
Once a “rock star” in the advertising industry, Kirsten, 58, now needs help with most basic tasks, including dressing, taking a shower, brushing her teeth, and eating. A string of inexperienced or unreliable home

care workers, one of whom was present when Kirsten tripped on a curb outside and fell, leaving her requiring stitches, have left Hano frustrated and heartbroken.
“Here I am trying to spend extra money for peace of mind or better service,” he said, “but it’s very clear that the availability of good folks is limited.”
In a state where barbers, manicurists, and massage therapists must be licensed, home

care agencies providing nonmedical support are subject to shockingly little oversight, despite the profound vulnerability of the people who rely on them.
Massachusetts is one of only four states without a licensing process for private, non-medical home care agencies, said Harrison Collins, director of legislative affairs for the Home Care Alliance of Massachusetts, an in- **HOME HEALTH, Page A7**

Boston mulls new source of revenue: its image

By Niki Griswold
GLOBE STAFF
Imagine T-shirts emblazoned with Boston’s city seal. Parks and Recreation Department coffee mugs. Boston police-branded sweat shirts, or Boston Public Library tote bags.
Ever wanted to don apparel representing your favorite city department? The opportunity could be close at hand.
City Hall officials are exploring the possibility of launching a city-branded merchandise licensing program — not only to sell official Boston swag to residents, tourists, and local government enthusiasts, but also to potentially trademark historic city symbols and department logos.
Proponents of the idea say it would boost civic pride and tourism, allow the city to protect and profit off its brand, and offer an opportunity for the city to collaborate with local designers and small businesses.
A merch program could also be a revenue stream for Boston and help pad the city’s coffers at a time when municipalities across Massachusetts are grappling with strained budgets, federal funding cuts, and state restrictions on imposing most new municipal taxes. Trade-marking city symbols, for example, could also allow the city to sell licenses for their use to third parties. **MERCHANDISE, Page A10**

HISTORY IN THE (RE)MAKING



Duncan McGhee worked on the thatched roof of Alden House, one of two replica replacement homes being rebuilt at Plimoth Patuxet Museums. **B1.**

Lawmakers vow oversight of US strikes

Two signal second attack on boat in Caribbean Sea may constitute war crime

By Michael Gold
NEW YORK TIMES
WASHINGTON — A top Republican and Democrats in Congress suggested Sunday that US military officials might have committed a serious crime in President Trump’s offensive against boats in the Caribbean after a news report said that during one such attack, a follow-up strike was ordered to kill survivors.
The remarks came in response to a Washington Post report Friday that said Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth had given a verbal order to kill everyone aboard boats suspected of smuggling drugs, and that this led a military commander to carry out a second strike to kill those who had initially survived an attack in early September.
“Obviously, if that occurred, that would be very serious, and I agree that that would be an illegal act,” Representative Mike Turner, an Ohio Republican and a former chair of the Intelligence Committee, said on “Face the Nation” on CBS.
Democratic Senator Tim Kaine of Virginia said on CBS that if the report was accurate, the attack “rises to the level of a war crime.” And on CNN, when asked whether he believed a second strike to **HEGSETH, Page A6**



In the news

Three years after Ana Walshe vanished, the murder trial of her husband, Brian, begins with opening statements Monday. **B1.**

Greater Boston asylum-seekers struggle with a new reality in their bid for a place in the United States after the Trump

administration announced more restrictions. **B1.**

The hiring of next year’s college graduates is expected to be stagnant as economic growth slows and the labor market falters. **D1.**

With the markets for hot coffee and cold drinks going in two directions, it was time to undo the Keurig-Dr Pepper

merger, Jon Chesto writes. **D1.**

Pope Leo XIV insisted once again on a two-state solution to resolve the Israeli-Palestinian troubles, as he traveled in the region. **A3.**

Hondurans voted to elect a new president only days after President Trump intervened in a close race with an endorsement and an announcement he would

pardon a former president convicted of helping push drugs into the United States. **A4.**

The suspect accused of shooting two National Guard members near the White House had been increasingly erratic in the past months, according to emails and advocates. **A2.**

The Celtics hold off the Cavaliers, 117-115. **C1.**

Shop til you slop

Monday: Cloud, sun mix.
Tuesday: Snow, rain, mush.
Weather and comics, **D4-5.**
Obituaries, **B6.**